

Kye Palmer

PhD Candidate in Psychology
Adelaide University

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Education

Doctor of Philosophy (Psychology)

Adelaide University, Adelaide, Australia

2023 – Present

Thesis: Interpretation and Production of Emotion in Family Contexts

Supervisors: Dr Nicole Nelson, Dr Mark Kohler

Honours Degree of Bachelor of Psychological Science

The University of Adelaide, Adelaide, Australia

2022

Class: First Class Honours

Thesis: The role of parent gender in infant-directed emotion expression in an established database of infant headcam videos

Bachelor of Psychological Science

The University of Adelaide, Adelaide, Australia

2019 – 2021

Research Experience

PhD Candidate – Develop Well Research Group

Adelaide University | 2023 – Present

Supervisors: Dr Nicole Nelson & Dr Mark Kohler

- Leading a program of research exploring how children learn to express, interpret, and communicate emotion across early childhood and adolescence.
- Investigating emotional communication within families, including parent–child and sibling interactions.
- Utilising mixed methods including behavioural observation, audiovisual stimuli, and repeated-measures designs.
- Experienced in advanced statistical analysis using R and Jamovi, including mixed-effects modelling.
- Research situated within developmental, social, and cognitive psychology.

Honours Student Researcher

The University of Adelaide | 2022

Supervisor: Dr Nicole Nelson

- Conducted an independent thesis examining parental gender differences in emotional expression toward infants
- Analysed audiovisual data from infant point-of-view headcam recordings

Publications & Manuscripts

Manuscripts Under Review

Palmer, K., Van Der Zant, T., Holdsworth, I., Rayner, C., Tuza, A., & Nelson, N. (2026). Infants' Everyday Exposure to Caregiver Facial Expressions: Evidence from Naturalistic Head-Mounted Camera Data <http://dx.doi.org/10.2139/ssrn.6175290>

Palmer, K., Buttle, H. M., Kohler, M., Fong, F. T. K., & Nelson, N. L. (2026). Parent-Child Facial Expression Recognition: The Role of Familiarity in Interactive Contexts.

Conference Presentations

Palmer, K., Buttle, H. M., Kohler, M., Fong, F. T. K., & Nelson, N. L. (2026). Expressive Communication in Families: Familiarity and Accuracy in an Interaction Emotion Recognition Task. Oral presentation at the International Society for Research on Emotion Conference (ISRE), Brisbane, QLD, Australia.

Palmer, K., Buttle, H. M., Kohler, M., Fong, F. T. K., & Nelson, N. L. (2025). Parent-child emotion recognition: The role of familiarity in interactive contexts. Oral presentation at the joint Australasian Experimental Psychology Conference (EPC) & Asia Pacific Conference on Vision (APCV), Sydney, NSW, Australia.

Palmer, K., Holdsworth, I., Rayner, C., Tuza, A., Van Der Zant, T., & Nelson, N. L. (2024). Infant-directed emotional expressions in everyday life: The role of parent gender and infant age. Poster presented at the Australasian Experimental Psychology Conference (EPC), Adelaide, SA, Australia.

Van Der Zant, T., Holdsworth, I., **Palmer, K.**, Rayner, C., Tuza, A., & Nelson, N. L. (2022, November 24–26). Emotional expressions in infants' environment. Conference presentation at the Society of Australasian Social Psychologists, Adelaide, SA, Australia.

Teaching Experience

Tutor & Marker – Health & Lifespan Development (PSYC 3040)

Adelaide University | 2026

Third-year course covering psychological and social influences on health

- Topics included mental health, culture and infancy, adolescent development
- Led 8 tutorial groups, fortnightly
- Marked Registered Report assignments

Tutor & Marker – Introductory Research Methods in Psychology (PSYC1000)

Adelaide University | 2026

- First-year course on research methods in psychology
- Core focus on quantitative designs, qualitative designs, and research ethics
- Teaching across 3 tutorial groups, weekly. One class hosted online only.
- Marking for 3 assignments across the semester.

Tutor & Marker – Research Methods in Psychology (PSYCHOL 1004)

The University of Adelaide | 2024 – 2025

- First-year course on research methods in psychology
- Led 3–5 tutorial groups, fortnightly
- Marked written Applied Paper assessment
- Invigilated end-of-semester exam

Tutor – Foundations of Health & Lifespan Development (PSYCHOL 2005)

The University of Adelaide, Adelaide University | 2024

- Second-year course on development across childhood, adulthood and older age
- Taught topics including resilience and play & independence
- Delivered 15 tutorials over a two-week block

Tutor & Marker – Health & Lifespan Development (PSYCHOL 3021)

The University of Adelaide | 2024 – 2025

- Third-year course covering psychological and social influences on health
- Topics included mental health, culture and infancy, adolescent development
- Led 3 tutorial groups, fortnightly
- Marked Registered Report assignments

Research Skills

Statistical Analysis & Software

- Proficient in Jamovi, JASP, R Studio, Excel; experienced with GLMMs, LMMs, and ANOVA
- Data wrangling, behavioural coding, and visualisation

Research Equipment & Software

- Experienced with iMotions and Affectiva AFFDEX
- Experienced with Tobii eye-tracking software and equipment, and AOI analysis

Research Design & Data Collection

- Designed and ran lab and museum-based studies with children aged 4–14
- Created Qualtrics studies including gamified tasks with embedded videos

Academic Communication & Peer Review

- Peer reviewed for: Cognitive Development, Affective Science, Psychological Science, Journal of Experimental Child Psychology
- Presented at national and international conferences; strong APA writing and manuscript prep skills

Teaching & Academic Support

- Delivered tutorials, marked assessments, and supported student learning

Honours Supervision

- Co-supervised a student on an honours thesis project in 2026, looking at local and global processing of children's emotional expressions.
- Led the overall design of the study and method
- Provided feedback on drafts, and participated in regular weekly meetings

Awards & Scholarships

Excellence in Tutoring Award – Nominee

School of Psychology, The University of Adelaide | 2024

- Nominated for outstanding undergraduate teaching

References

Dr Nicole Nelson

Senior Lecturer, School of Psychology, Adelaide University

nicole.nelson@adelaide.edu.au

Primary PhD Supervisor | PSYCHOL 3021 and PSYC 3040 Course Coordinator

Dr Mark Kohler

Senior Lecturer, School of Psychology, Adelaide University

mark.kohler@adelaide.edu.au

Secondary PhD Supervisor

Dr Deanne Green

Lecturer, School of Psychology, Adelaide University

deanne.green@adelaide.edu.au

PSYCHOL 1004 Course Coordinator